

LinkedIn Referral Message Templates you can steal!

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These templates helped me get referrals at Talabat, Careem, Amazon, Apparel Group and other major organisations in Dubai.

Template 1: Complete Stranger at Target Company

USE WHEN: ZERO PRIOR CONTACT. YOU FOUND THEM BECAUSE THEY WORK SOMEWHERE YOU WANT IN.

Hi [Name],

Found your profile while looking into [Company]. I'm genuinely interested in the [Job Title] role (Job ID: XXXX) and wanted to reach out to someone on the inside before just throwing my CV into the void.

I know we've never spoken, so I'll keep this short and make it easy.

I have [X years] in [your field], most recently at [Company] where I worked on [one relevant thing]. I think I'm a solid fit for this role specifically because of [one thing from the JD].

If you're open to referring me, here's everything you'd need:

LinkedIn: [link]

Portfolio/work samples: [link]

A line you can use: "[Your name] has a strong background in [X]. Their experience in [Y] maps well to what this role needs."

And if it doesn't feel right, genuinely no pressure. I'd still appreciate any advice on who best to reach out to.

[Your name]

Why it works: Gives them a copy-paste referral line so the effort is near zero. The offer of an alternative at the end reduces pressure and makes the yes easier.

Template 2: Weak Tie — Connected But Never Spoken

USE WHEN: YOU'RE CONNECTED, MAYBE LIKED EACH OTHER'S POSTS, BUT NEVER HAD AN ACTUAL CONVERSATION.

Hi [Name],

We connected a while back. I'm in the middle of a job search and [Company] is genuinely at the top of my list. I came across the [Job Title] opening (Job ID: XXXX) and the more I looked into it, the more I felt like it was written for my background, specifically around [relevant experience].

I know we haven't really spoken before so I want to be upfront. I'm not asking you to go out on a limb for a stranger. I just want to give you enough to make a proper call:

What I do: [2 sentences]

Why this role specifically: [1 sentence]

LinkedIn + work: [links]

Referral line if you're comfortable: "[Name] has [X] experience. Their background in [Y] is directly relevant to this role."

If it's not a yes, that's completely fair. Referrals mean something and you should only put your name behind someone you actually feel good about.

[Your name]

Why it works: Acknowledging "referrals mean something" validates their hesitation and builds trust. Most people skip this and it's the thing that makes the message land differently.

Template 3: Alumni — Same College or Former Company

USE WHEN: YOU SHARE A COMMON INSTITUTION. BUILT-IN "US" DYNAMIC EVEN IF YOU'VE NEVER MET.

Hi [Name],

Fellow [College/Company] alum here. I came across your profile and noticed you're at [Company] now. Congratulations on the role, genuinely looks like a great move.

I'm currently looking at my next step and [Company] has been on my radar for a while. I saw the [Job Title] opening (Job ID: XXXX) and it aligns really well with what I've been building toward.

Figured I'd reach out to a familiar face before going through the formal process. Here's the full picture so you can decide if it's worth putting your name behind:

Quick background: [2 sentences, where you've been and what you do]

Why this role: [1 sentence, specific to the JD]

LinkedIn + portfolio: [links]

Referral line: "We're both [College/Company] alumni. I've looked at [Name]'s background and think they'd be a strong fit for this role."

[Your name]

Why it works: The alumni connection is social proof by default. It's not a cold ask, it's a same-team ask. "Familiar face" and "before going through the formal process" signals you're treating them as an insider, not a transaction.

Template 4: Former Colleague — Someone You've Actually Worked With

USE WHEN: YOU'VE SHARED A WORKPLACE, EVEN BRIEFLY. YOUR HIGHEST-CONVERSION SCENARIO.

Hi [Name],

Been a minute! Saw your recent [post / promotion / update] and it made me smile. Looks like things are going well on your end.

I'm looking at my next move and [Company] kept coming up as somewhere I'd actually love to be. There's a [Job Title] role open (Job ID: XXXX) and the more I read into it the more it felt right.

Given that we've worked together I wanted to ask you directly. Would you be comfortable referring me? Here's everything so you don't have to chase anything down:

What I've been up to since [Company]: [1-2 sentences]

Why this one specifically: [1 sentence]

LinkedIn + recent work: [links]

A line for the form: "I worked with [Name] at [Company]. They're strong at [X] and consistently delivered on [Y]."

And if you'd rather point me toward someone specific on the team to reach out to instead, I'm totally happy with that too. Either way, would love your honest take on whether it's worth going for.

[Your name]

Why it works: The only template where warmth can come first. Offering an alternative at the end removes pressure and paradoxically makes a direct yes more likely.

The one thing all four templates share: a pre-written referral line. Most people don't refer not because they won't, but because they don't know what to write. Write it for them.